

Morning Consult



Where Voters Get Their Information

Polling by **Morning Consult** on behalf of the **Bipartisan Policy Center**

Methodology

3,144

Registered voters interviewed
nationwide

$\pm 2\%$

Margin of error

September
2-4, 2026

2026 field dates

Results are weighted to approximate a target sample of registered voters based on gender, age, race, educational attainment, region, gender by age, and race by educational attainment. Questions with subgroups of fewer than n=100 are not reported.

Key Takeaways

01

Voters seek election results more frequently than they look for registration or process information. One-in-four voters say they never look for information on how to register to vote (26%) or on how elections are run (24%) – compared with 10% who say they never seek information about election results.

02

Television and social media dominate voters' go-to sources for information. Roughly one-third of voters report sourcing election news and information from national TV (36%) or local TV (31%), and 35% say they get their election information from social media. AI chatbots are not relied on (5%). Among those who use television, ABC (41%), FOX (40%), and NBC (37%) are the top channels used. For social media, voters rely on Facebook (71%), YouTube (58%), and Instagram (49%) the most.

03

Voters go to different sources depending on the question. 36% of voters turn to online search engines for information on how to register and vote, and 31% look to election officials. For understanding how elections are run, search engines lead (35%), with news media close behind (28%). For finding out results, news media dominates (53%), more than any other source.

04

Voters rarely use AI themselves for election information and remain split on spotting it. Two-thirds voters (65%) assume AI is used in the election content they seek online at least some of the time, yet just one-in-five report using AI regularly for election-related questions (21%), and half (49%) are confident they can identify AI-created election content, while 40% are not. Voters are more open to AI use for information but worry about relying on AI for deciding who to vote for (56%) or for advertising (57%).

05

Confidence in vote-counting is stronger locally, and misinformation tops voters' concerns heading into midterms. 80% of voters are confident their vote will be counted as intended in their own county or city, falling to 69% nationwide. Voters' top concerns are AI-driven disinformation (72%) and misleading election information (68%). These concerns are shared across party lines.

- 01 How often voters seek election information
- 02 The channels voters use
- 03 Three information needs, compared
- 04 AI in the election information environment
- 05 Confidence, concerns and policy

Contents

01

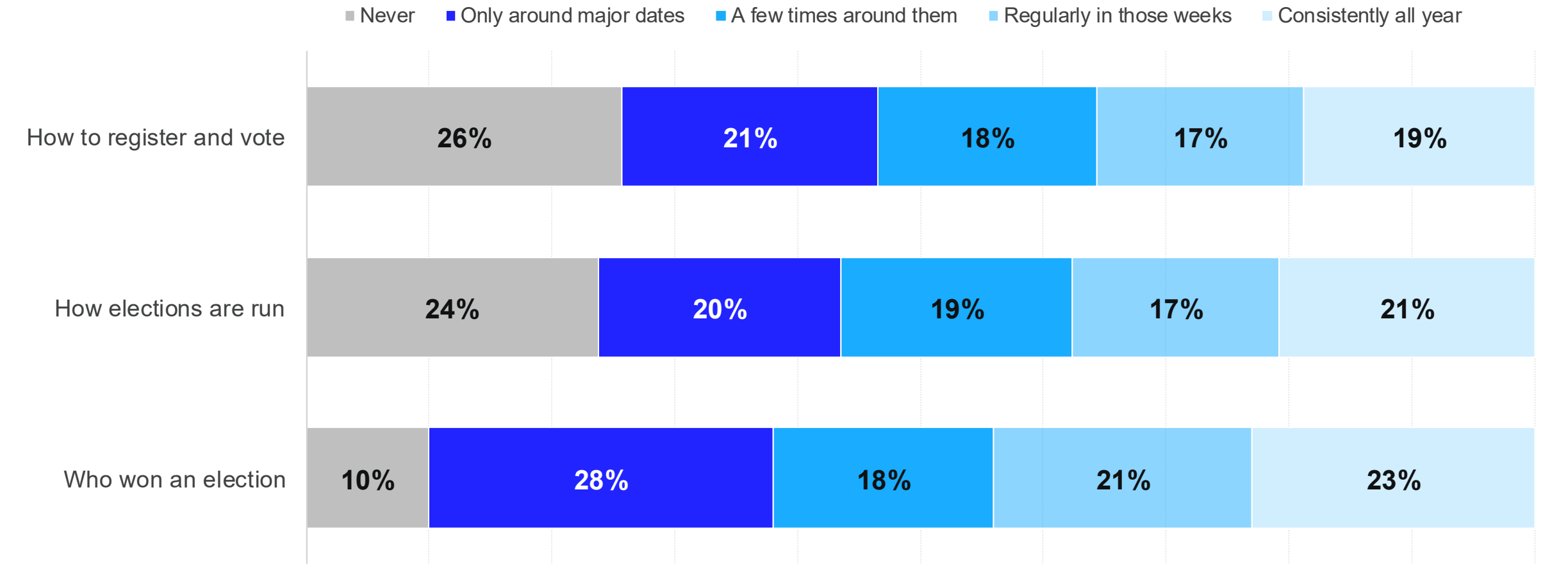
How often voters seek election information

Frequency of information-seeking across three needs, and the share who never look at all.



A quarter of registered voters never seek information about how to register — but almost everyone checks who won.

How often do you seek out the following kinds of information about elections, if at all?



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 3,144. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

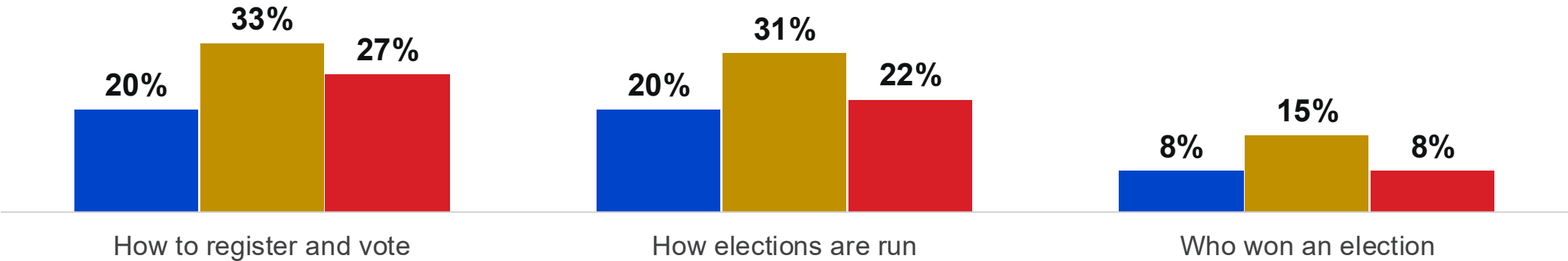


Independents are the least engaged, with one-third saying they never look for registration or election process information.

How often do you seek out the following kinds of information about elections, if at all?

Voters Who Say They Never Seek This Information

■ Democrats ■ Independents ■ Republicans



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Democrats: n = 1,123; Independents: n=816; Republicans: n=1,204. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

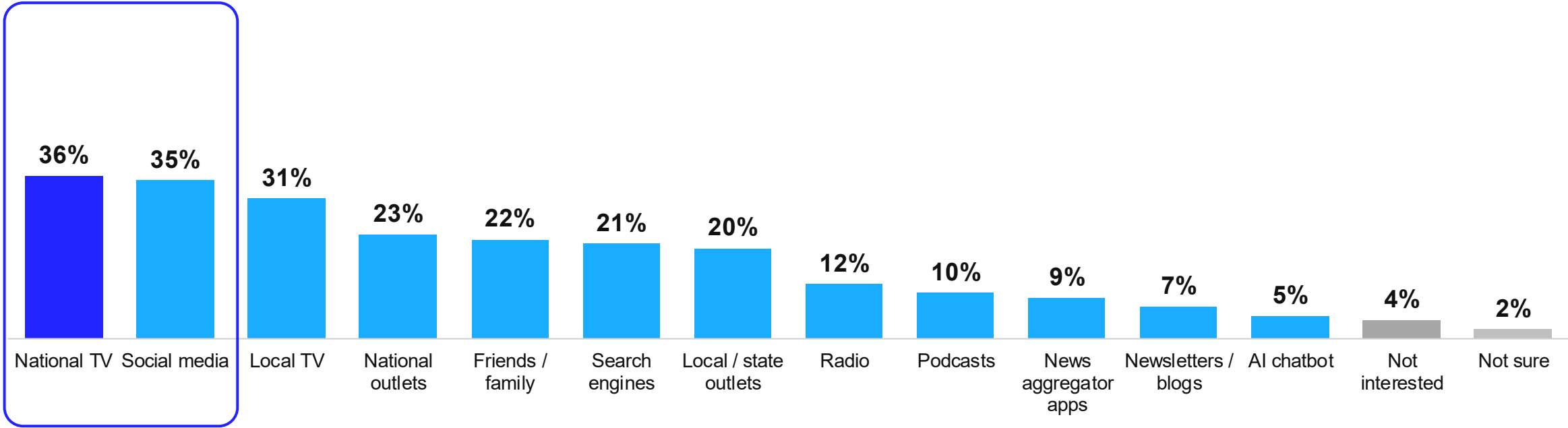


National television and social media lead in the top sources from which voters get their news and information about elections.

People get news and information about elections in many different ways. Which do you use most often? Please select up to three.

Sources for Election News and Information

% selected

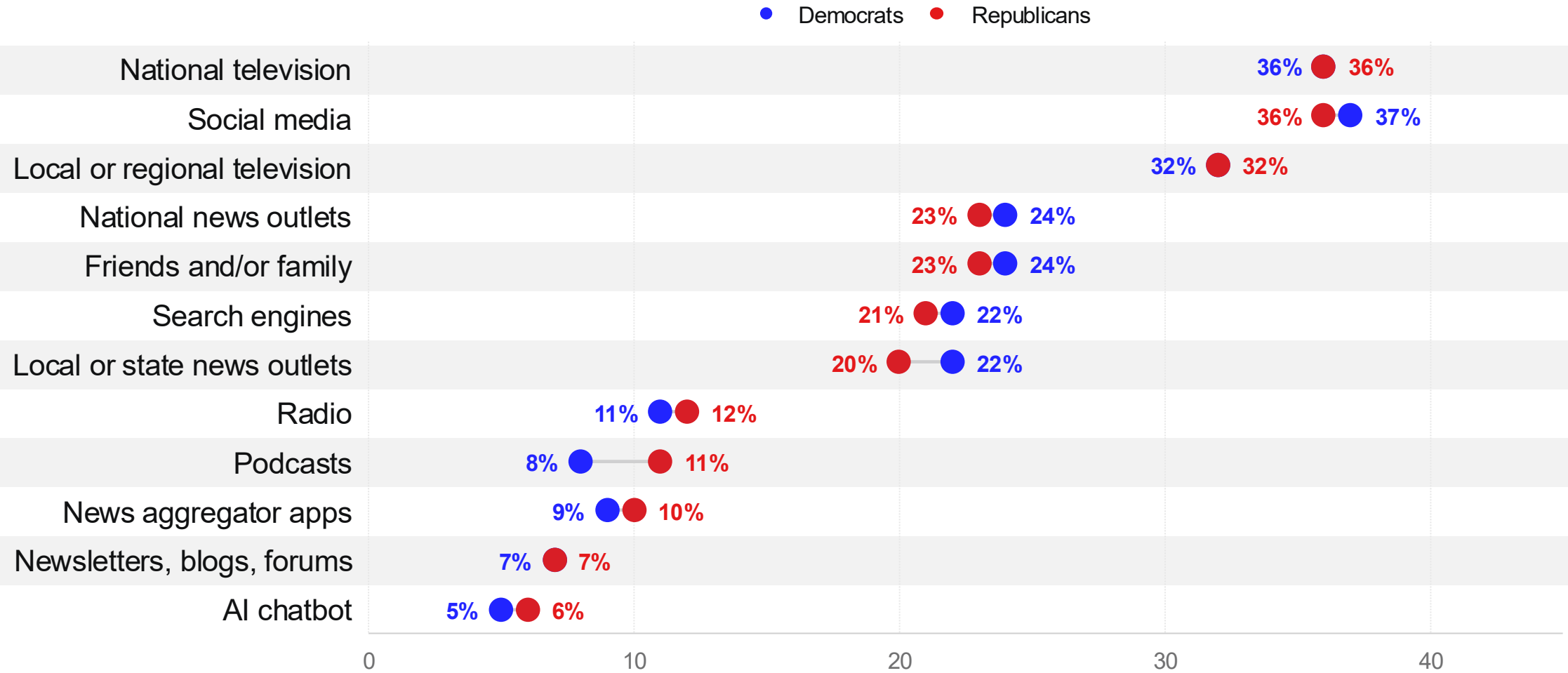


Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 3,144; ‘Other’ not shown (1% selected); percentages sum to more than 100.



Democrats and Republicans both rely on national and local television, and social media more than any other sources for information about elections.

People get news and information about elections in many different ways. Which do you use most often? Please select up to three.



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Democrats: n = 1,123; Republicans: n=1,204. Independents not shown. Other, Not sure, and Not interested answer options not shown. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

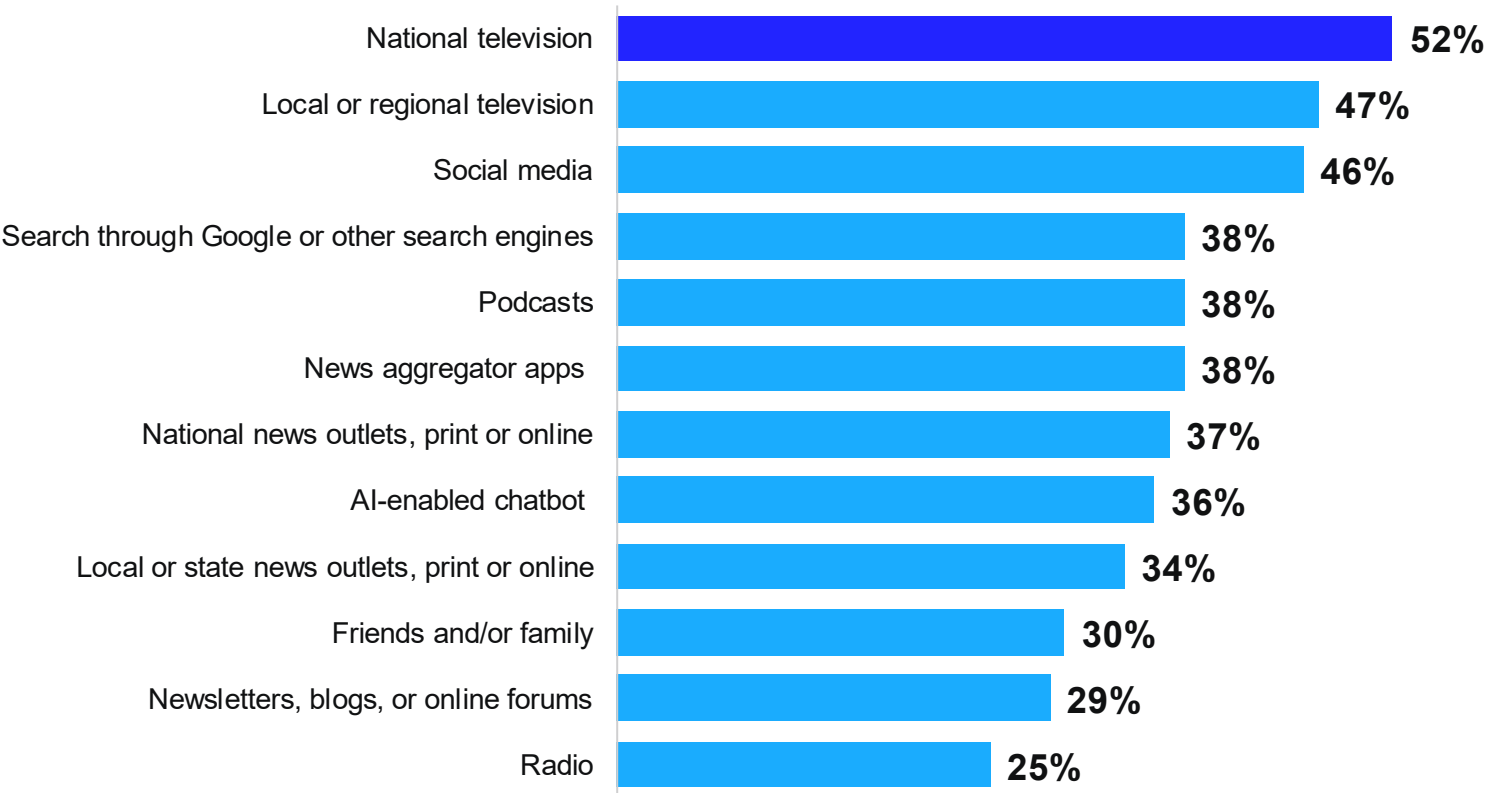


Among those who use each source for election information, half rank national or local television networks as the source they rely on the most. Similar shares of those who use social media for this information say it is their top source.

You indicated you get news and information about elections from the following sources. Please rank each source by dragging and dropping the sources in order, starting with the source you rely on the most (top) and ending with the source you rely on the least (bottom) for news and information about elections.

Top Sources for Election News and Information – Among Users

% Rank # 1



02

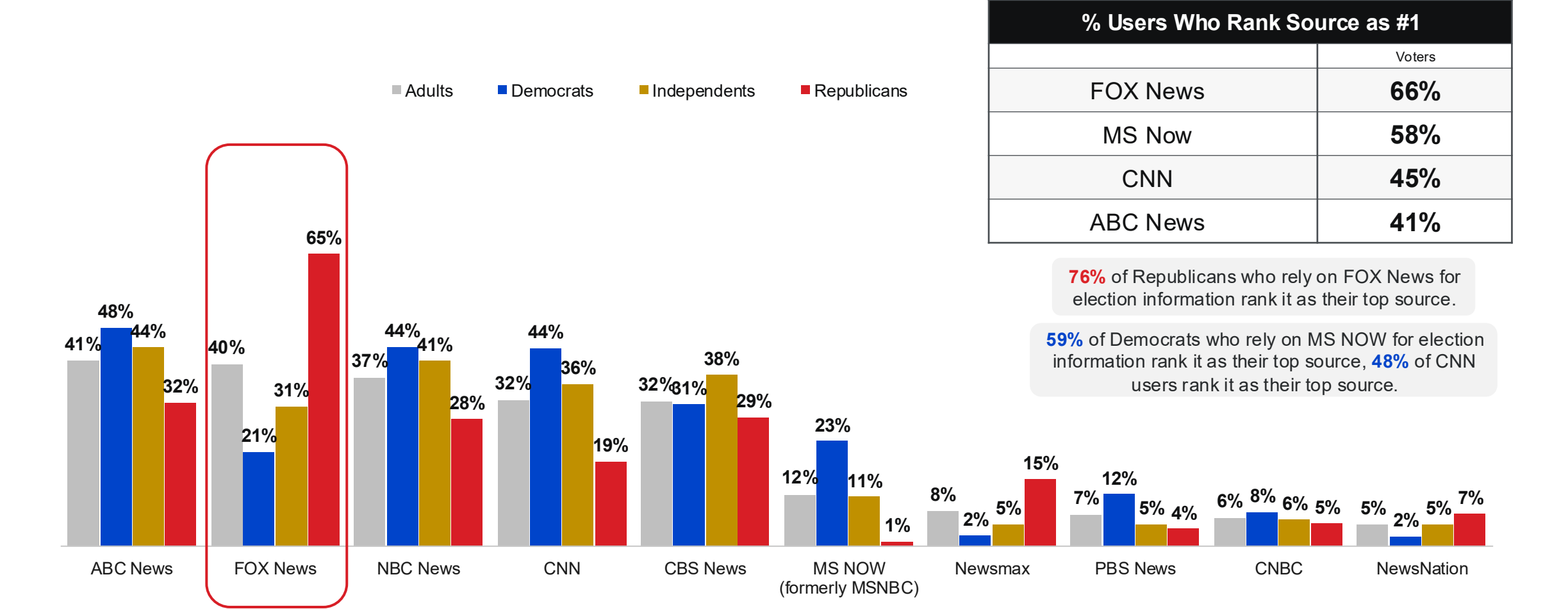
The channels voters use

Television networks, print and online outlets, radio, social platforms and AI chatbots — asked of the voters who selected each channel.



Republicans who get their election information from national television are most likely to look to FOX News, whereas independents and Democrats are divided between multiple sources.

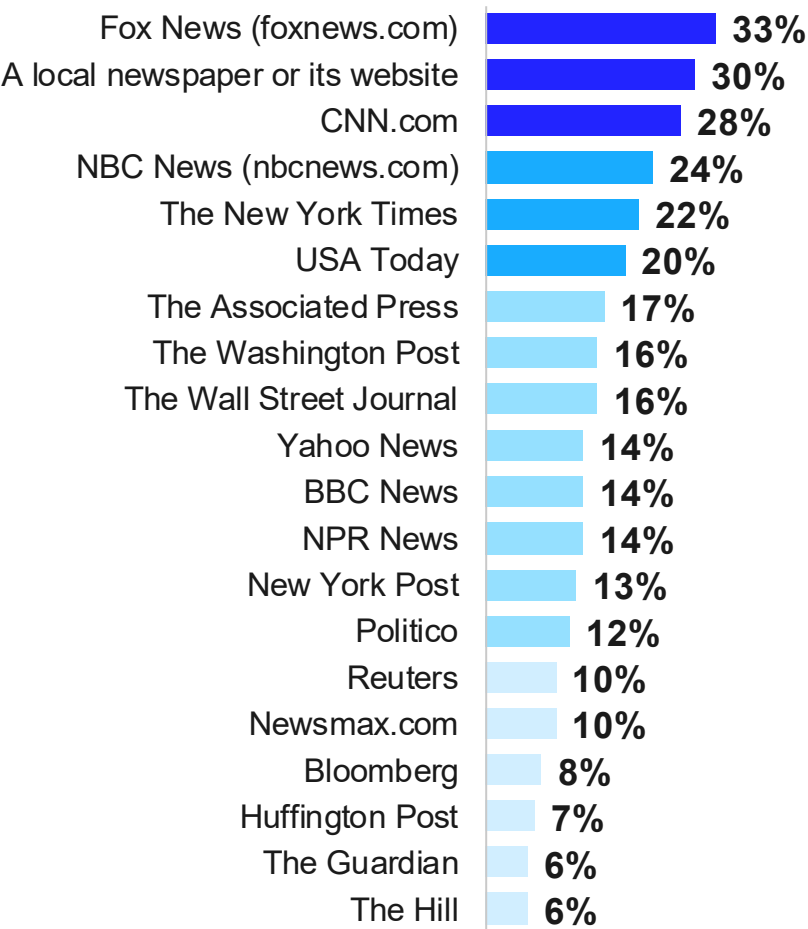
You mentioned getting news and information about elections from **national television**. Which of the following national television networks do you use most often to get election information? Please select up to three. | Please rank each source by dragging and dropping the sources in order, starting with the source you rely on the most (top) and ending with the source you rely on the least (bottom) for news and information about elections.



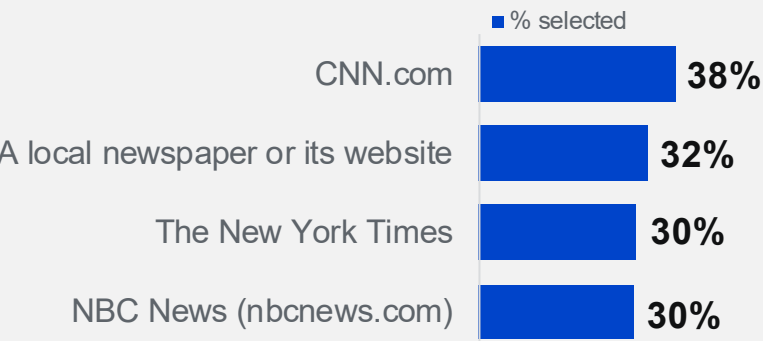
Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Democrats: n = 409, Independents: n=289; Republicans: n=435. Asked of voters who named national television as a main source. Top 10 of 13 sources listed.

Among those who get their election news from print or online news outlets, Fox News, CNN, and local newspapers top the list.

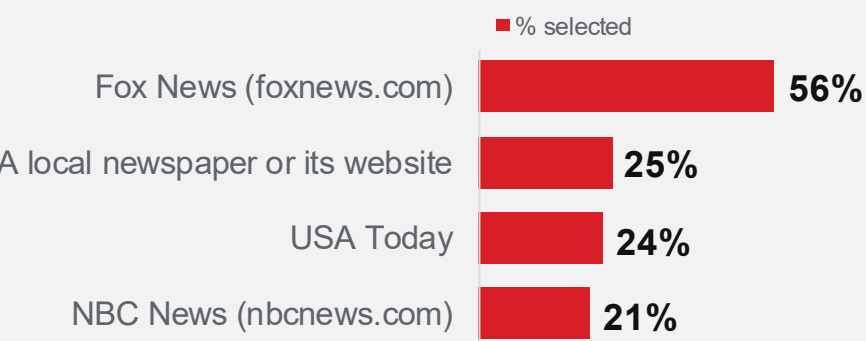
You mentioned getting news and information about elections from **print or online news outlets**. Which of the following outlets do you use most often to get election information? Select all that apply.



Democrats – Top 4 Sources



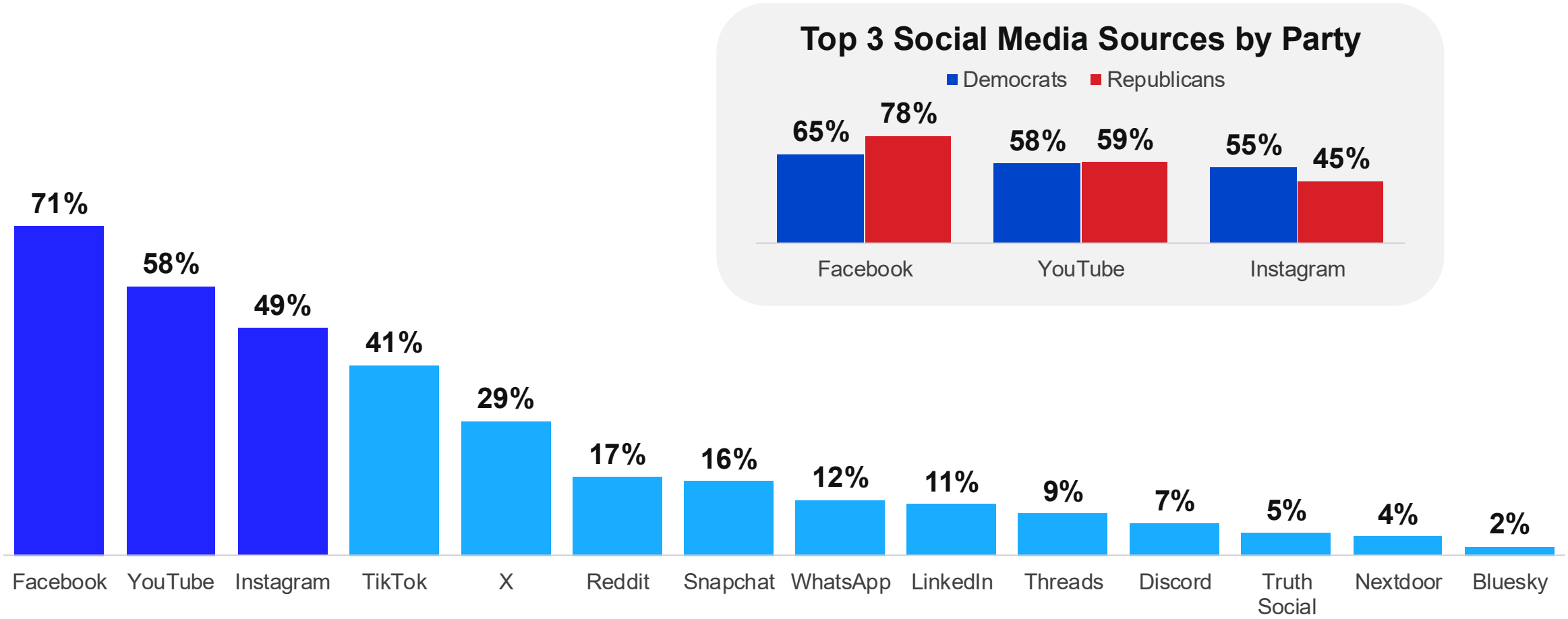
Republicans – Top 4 Sources





Most voters who rely on social media for election information look to Facebook or YouTube.

You mentioned getting news and information about elections from **social media**. Which of the following social media platforms do you use most often to get election information? Select all that apply.



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 1,092. Asked of voters who named social media as a main source.

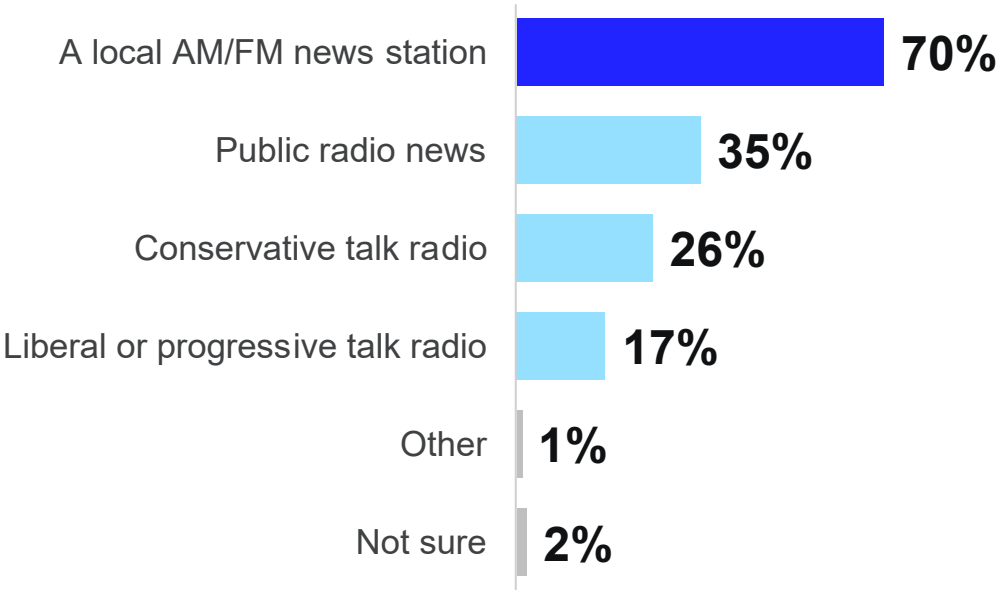


Most voters who rely on radio stations hear election information from their local AM / FM news station, and most voters who rely on AI use ChatGPT.

Which of the following **radio stations** do you use most often to get election information? Please select up to three. | Please rank each source by dragging and dropping the sources in order, starting with the source you rely on the most (top) and ending with the source you rely on the least (bottom) for news and information about elections. | Which **AI-enabled chatbots** do you use most often to get election information? Please select all that apply.

Radio stations

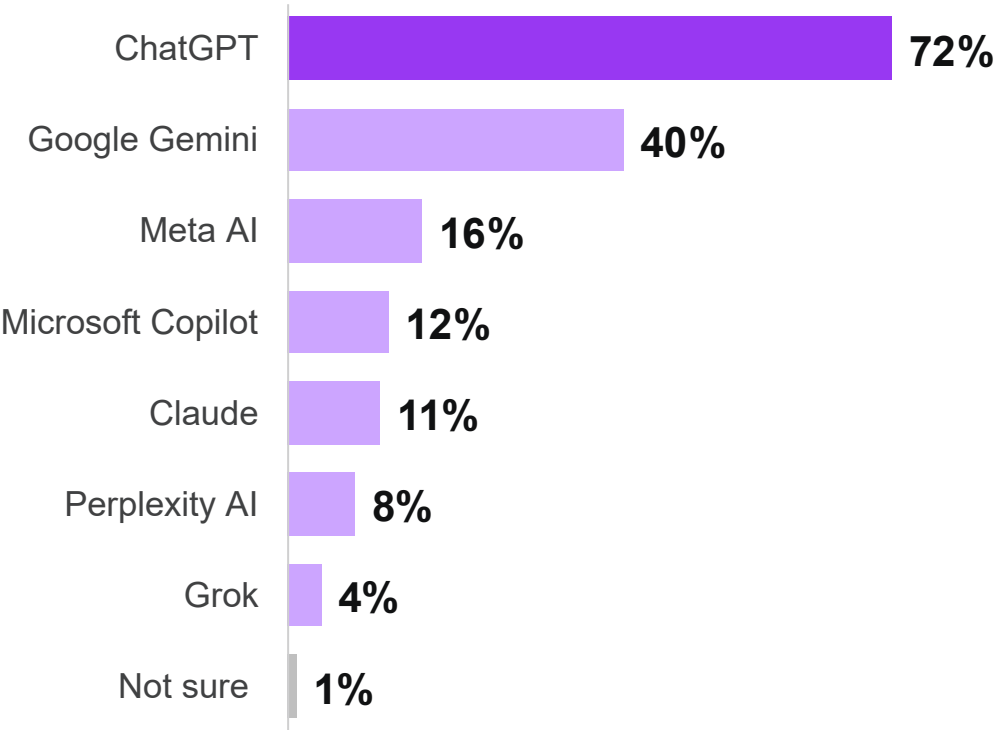
Among the 12% who named radio



76% of those who use local AM/FM news stations for election information rank them as their #1 source. 66% of public radio news users rely on it the most.

AI chatbots

Among the 5% who named an AI chatbot



03

Where voters seek registration, election process, and results information

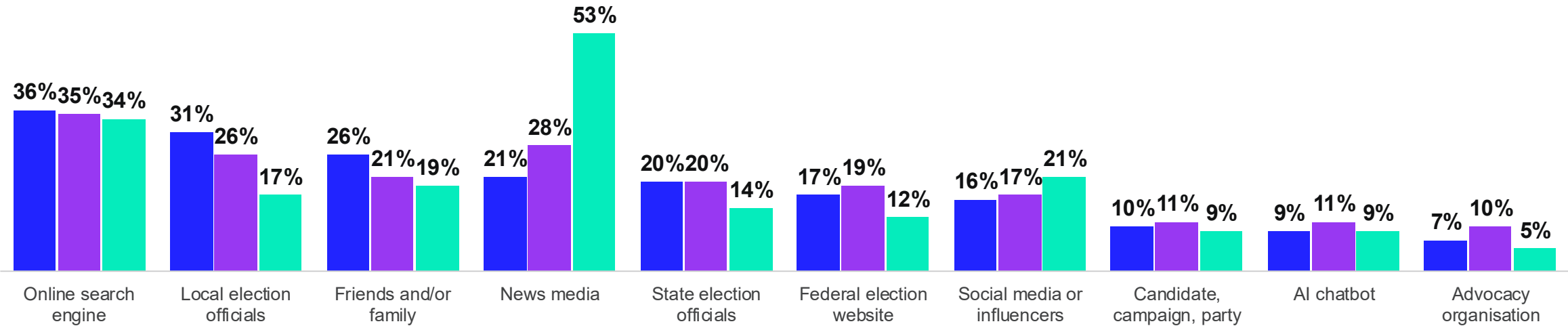
Where voters look to learn how to register, how elections are run, and who won — asked of those who seek each kind of information.

Search engines lead for information on how to register and vote and how elections are run. News media dominates searches for election results. Few voters look to AI chatbots.

You mentioned seeking information about how to register and vote / how elections are run / who won an election. Where do you typically look for that information? Please select up to three.

Likely Sources – Among Voters Who Seek Each Kind of Information

■ How to register and vote ■ How elections are run ■ Who won an election
% selected



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 2,329 / 2,401 / 2,840. Bases, in order: how to register and vote; how elections are run; who won an election. "Other" and "Don't know" answer options not charted, responses were ≤5%.

Across party, voters do online searches for registration and other process information, and they look to news media for election results.

Where do you typically look for that information? Please select up to three.

% selected	How to Register and Vote				How Elections are Run				Who Won an Election			
	Voters	Democrats	Independents	Republicans	Voters	Democrats	Independents	Republicans	Voters	Democrats	Independents	Republicans
Local election officials	31%	31%	32%	30%	26%	26%	27%	25%	17%	18%	14%	18%
State election officials	20%	21%	20%	20%	20%	22%	18%	20%	14%	14%	11%	15%
Federal election website	17%	18%	16%	16%	19%	19%	18%	19%	12%	12%	11%	12%
News media	21%	20%	19%	24%	28%	29%	24%	29%	53%	52%	57%	52%
Online search engine	36%	38%	38%	33%	35%	35%	39%	34%	34%	33%	38%	33%
Social media or influencers	16%	16%	14%	17%	17%	19%	15%	16%	21%	22%	18%	21%
Friends and/or family	26%	23%	23%	30%	21%	20%	17%	25%	19%	20%	14%	21%
Candidate, campaign, party	10%	11%	6%	10%	11%	13%	9%	10%	9%	10%	7%	9%
Advocacy organization	7%	9%	7%	6%	10%	11%	10%	9%	5%	6%	4%	5%
AI chatbot	9%	10%	8%	9%	11%	9%	10%	12%	9%	7%	7%	10%

Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 2,329 / 2,401 / 2,840; "Other" and "Don't know" answer options not charted, responses were ≤5%.

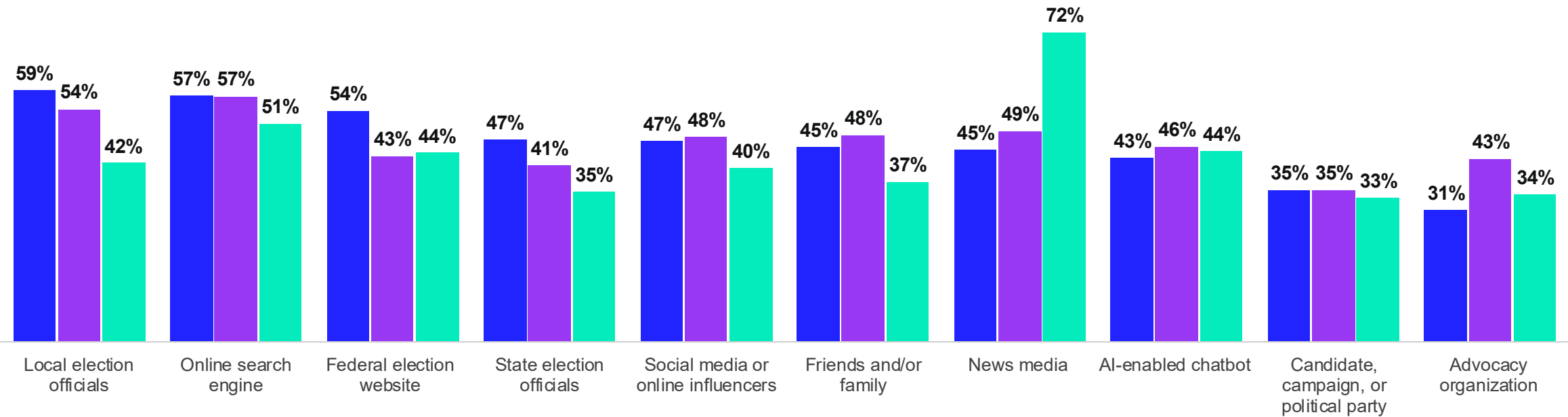
Among those who rely on each source, majorities say they rely on local election officials or online searches the most for registration and process information. For election results, three-in-four voters who rely on news media rank it as their top source.

You indicated you get this information from the following sources. Please rank each source by dragging and dropping the sources in order, starting with the source you rely on the most (top) and ending with the source you rely on the least (bottom) for news and information about how to register and vote / elections are run / who won an election.

Top Source – Among Voters Who Seek Each Kind of Information

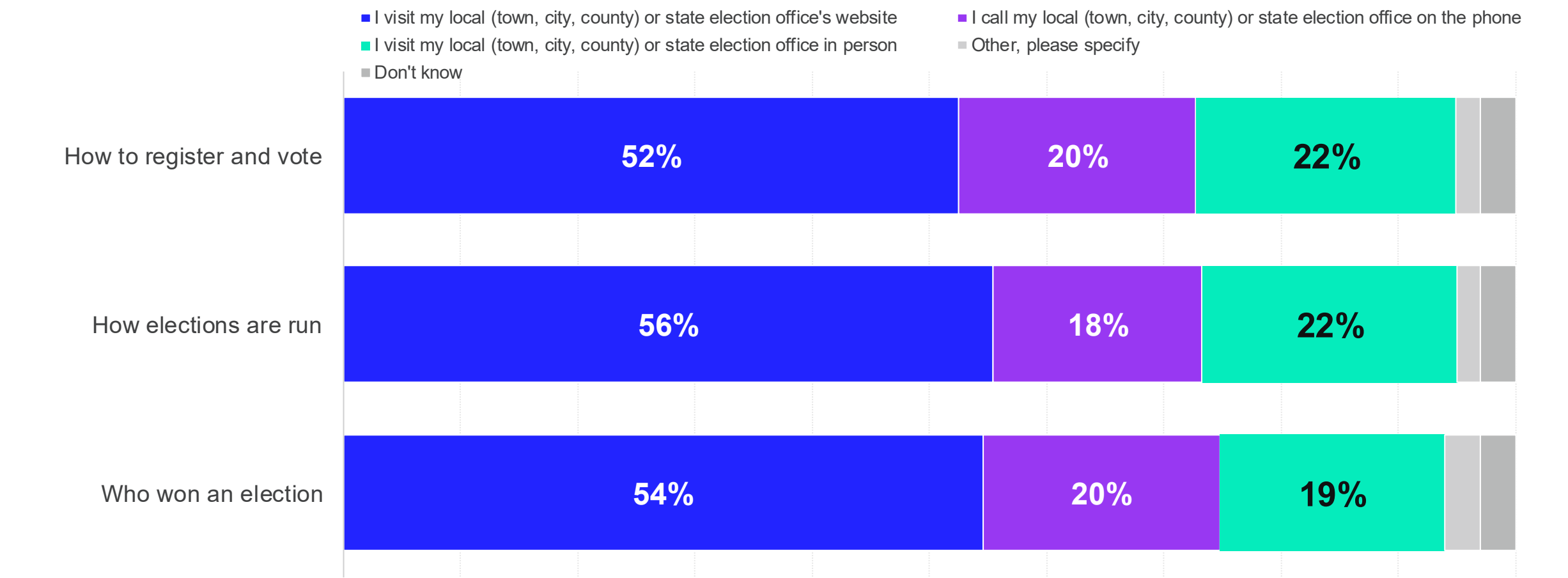
■ How to register and vote ■ How elections are run ■ Who won an election

% Rank 1



Voters who turn to election officials are more likely to go to the website, rather than going to the office or calling the office on the phone for process information and results.

How do you go about obtaining that information from election officials? Asked of voters who named local or state election officials as a source.

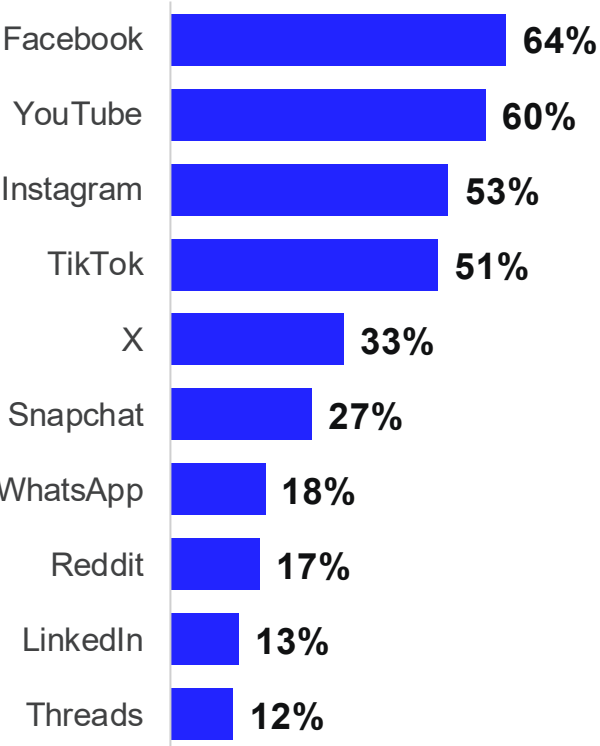


Voters who seek election process information and results from social media look to Facebook and YouTube the most, followed by Instagram and TikTok.

Which social media platform(s) do you use to obtain that information? Select all that apply. Asked of voters who named social media or online influencers for each need.

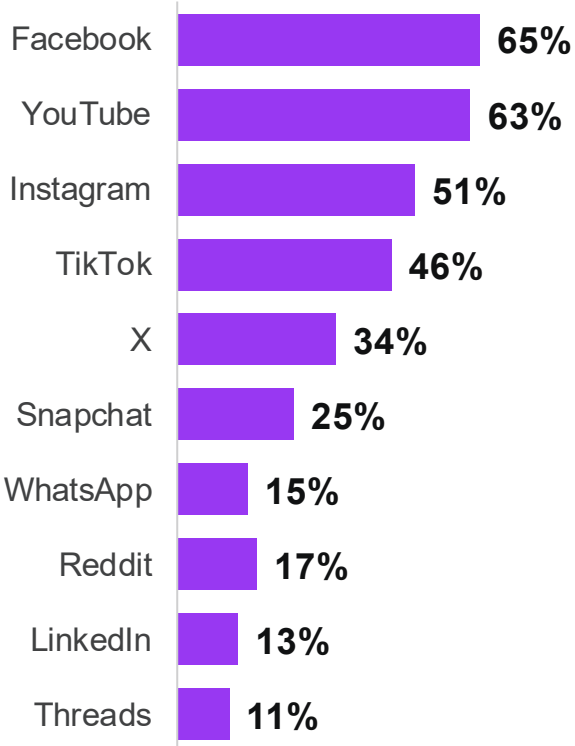
How to register and vote

n = 375



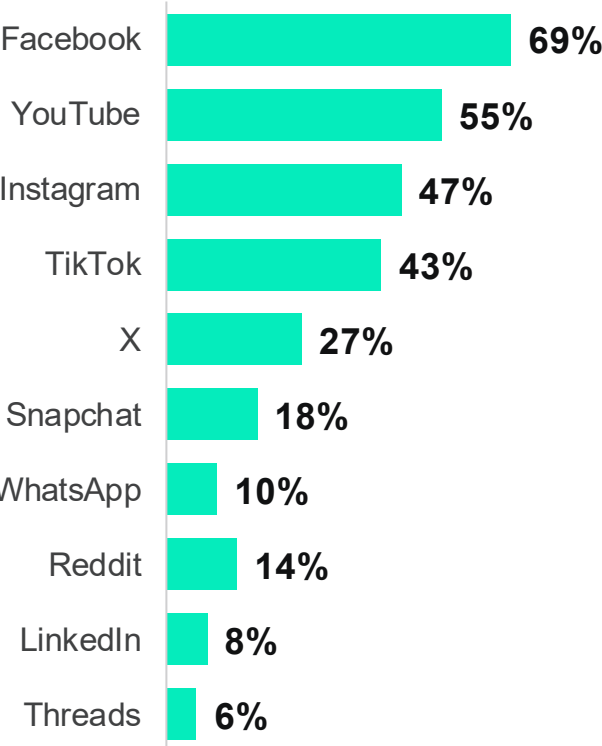
How elections are run

n = 404



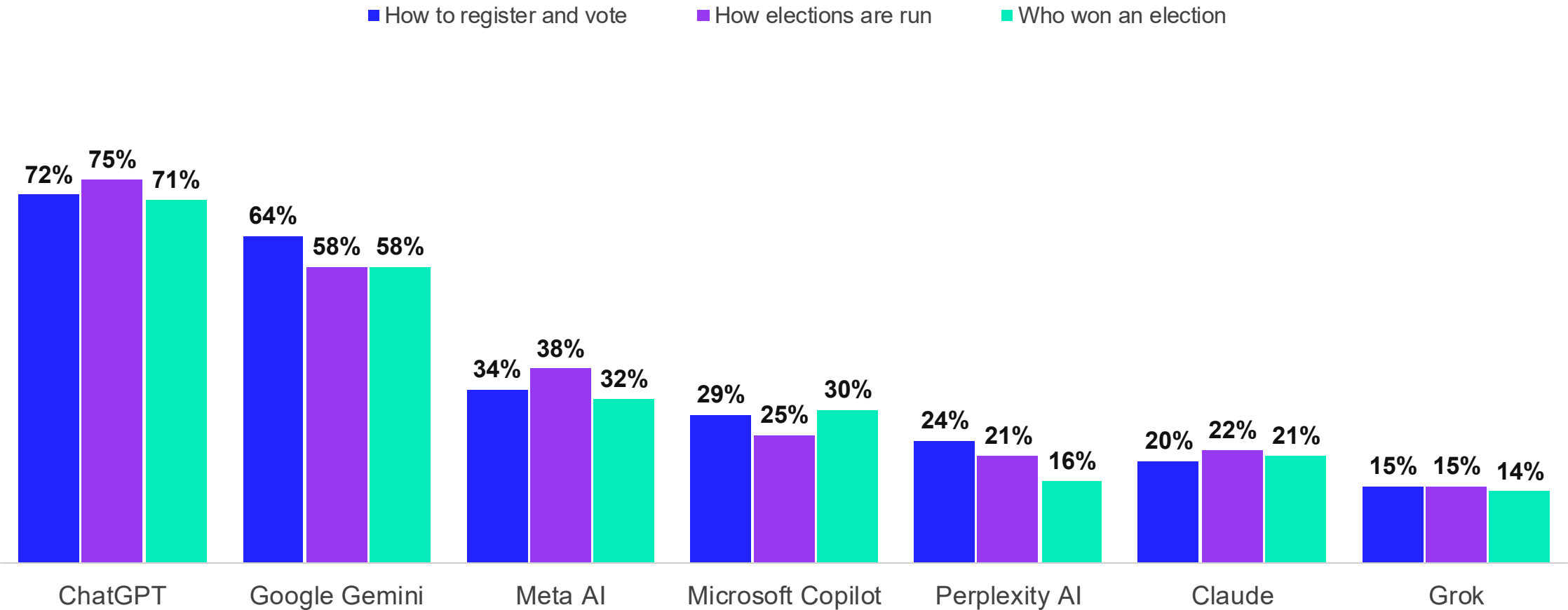
Who won an election

n = 585



Among those who use AI Chatbots for election information, the majority look to ChatGPT or Google Gemini.

Which AI-enabled chatbot(s) do you use to obtain that information? Select all that apply.



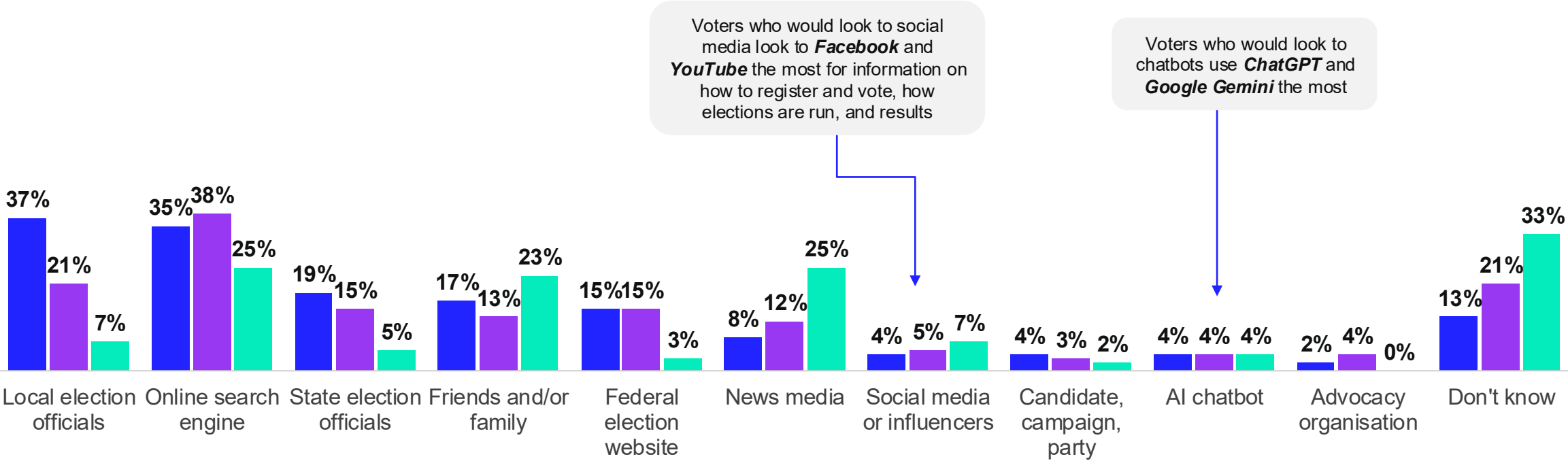
Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 211 / 252 / 242; "Other" and "Not sure" answer options not charted, responses were ≤3%.

Voters who never look default to search engines and local officials — or say they simply do not know.

You mentioned never seeking information about how to register and vote / how elections are run / who won an election. If you had to look for that information, where do you think you would most likely look? Please select up to three. *Asked of voters who said they never seek each kind of information.*

Likely Sources – Among Voters Who Never Seek Each Kind of Information

■ How to register and vote ■ How elections are run ■ Who won an election
% selected

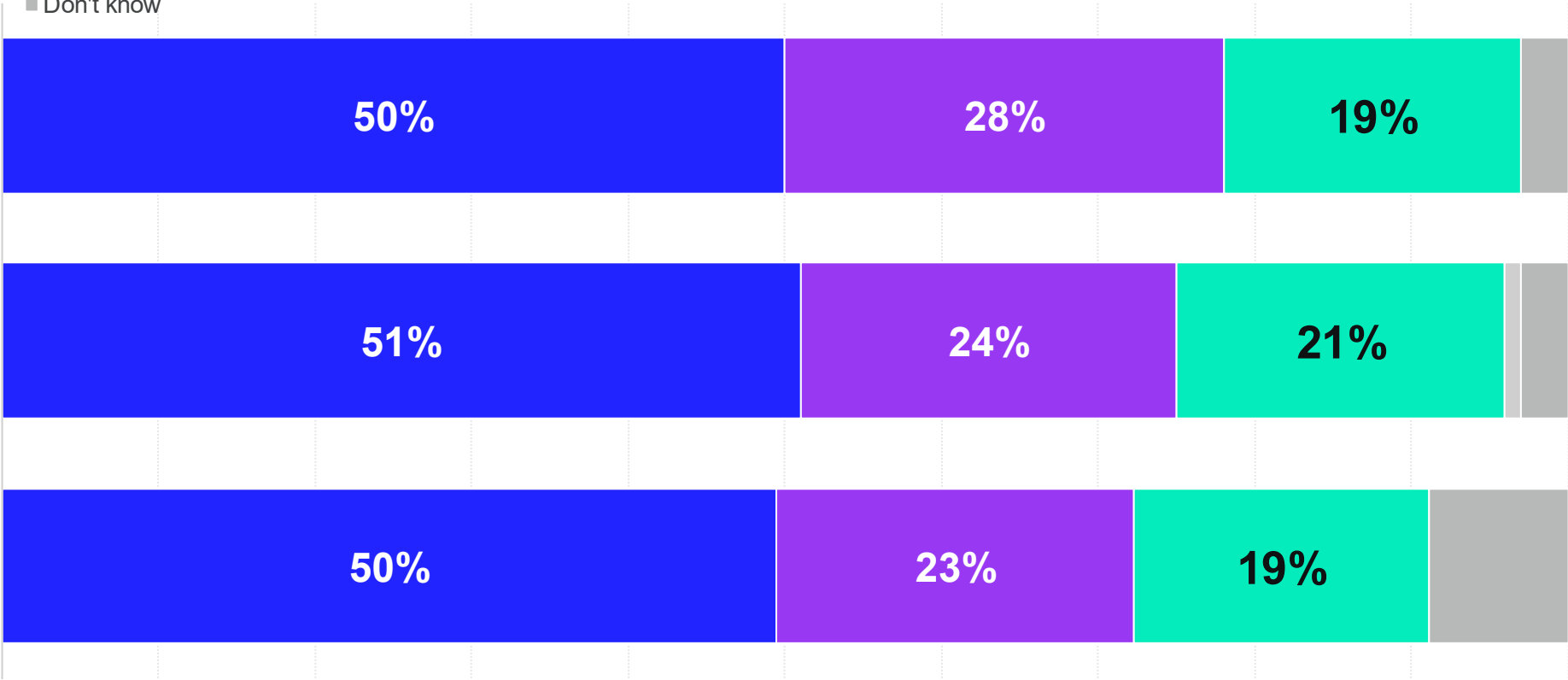


Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 815 / 743 / 304. Platform- and chatbot-level follow-ups among voters who never seek information have small bases (bases range from n = 15 to n = 41). "Other" answer option not included in the chart.

Voters who would turn to election officials would primarily visit the office’s website for information on voter registration, how elections are run, and election results.

You mentioned that you would most likely look to election officials for information about how to register and vote / how elections are run / who won an election. How do you think you would go about obtaining that information from election officials? *Among those who never seek the following information.*

- I visit my local (town, city, county) or state election office's website
- I call my local (town, city, county) or state election office on the phone
- I visit my local (town, city, county) or state election office in person
- Other, please specify
- Don't know



04

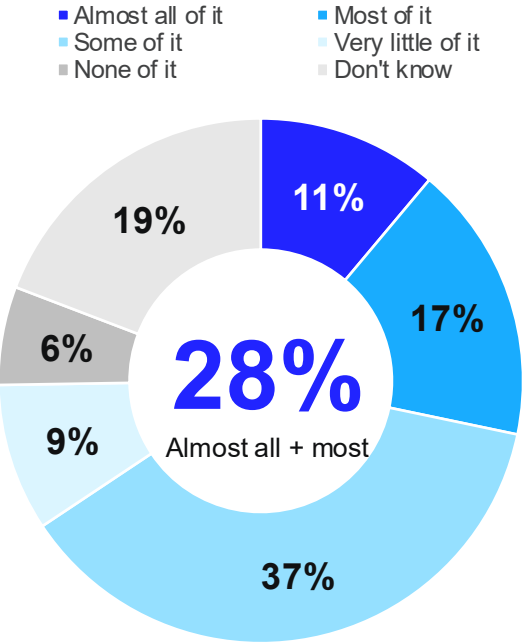
AI in the election information environment

How much online election content voters think is AI-made, whether they could tell, and which uses they accept.

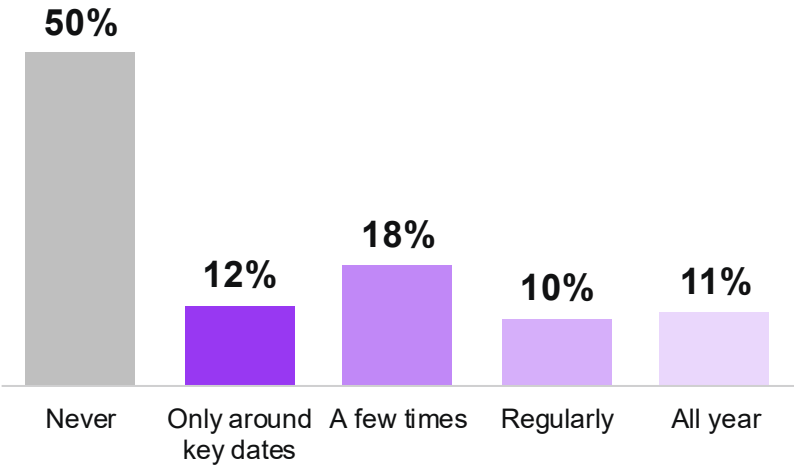
Few voters assume most or all election content is AI-created, rarely use it themselves, and are split on whether they could spot it.

Thinking about the election information you come across online, how much of it do you think is created using artificial intelligence (AI)? | How frequently do you choose to use AI tools (like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude) to ask questions about elections or get information about elections? | How confident are you that you could tell whether election content you see online was created by artificial intelligence (AI)?

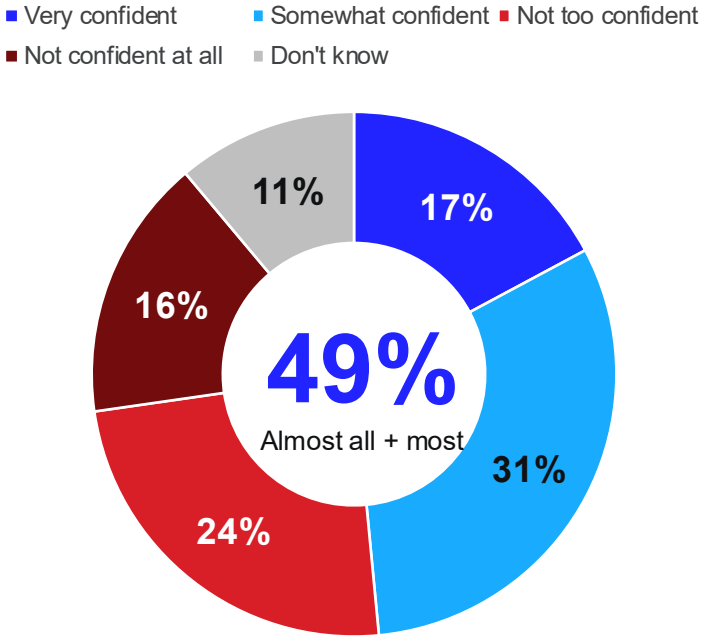
How much online election content is AI-created?



How often do you use AI tools to ask about elections?

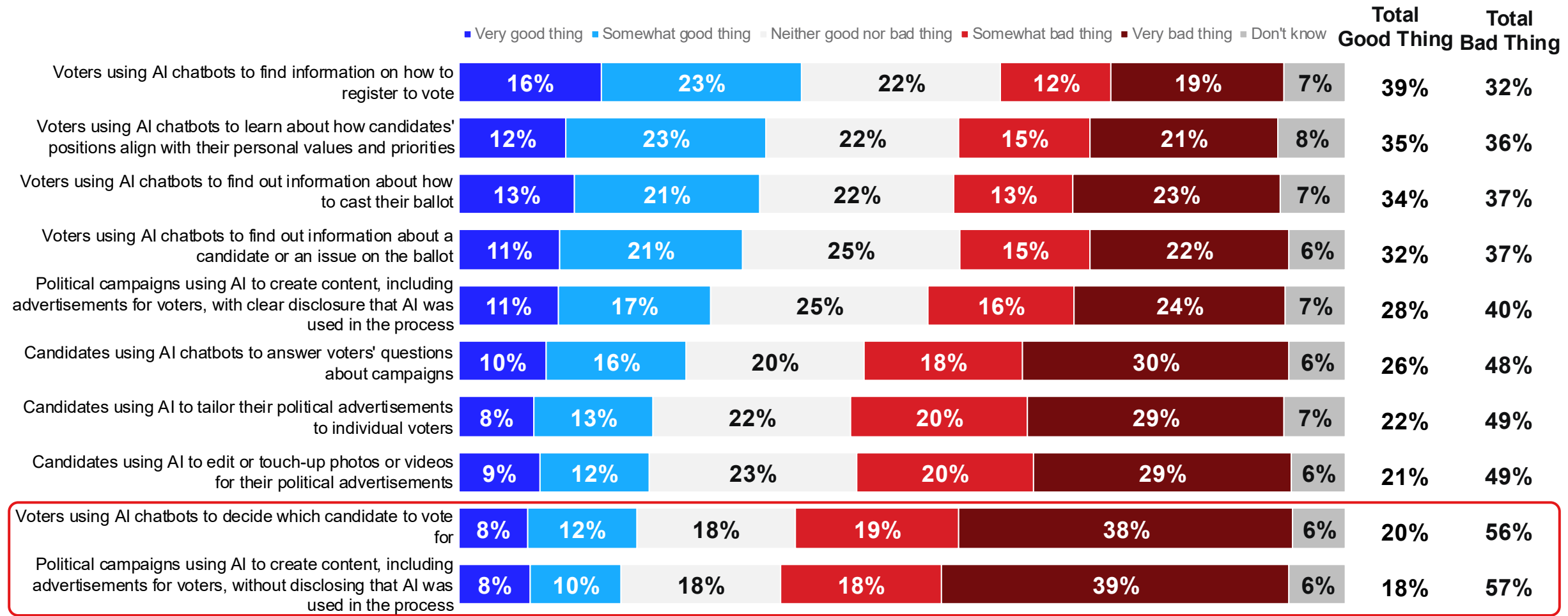


Could you tell whether election content was AI-created?



More than a third of voters tolerate AI use for looking up information on registration or candidate positions, but most reject AI use for deciding whom to vote for and for political campaign content without disclosure.

When it comes to the 2026 midterm elections, do you think each of the following would generally be a good thing, a bad thing, or neither good nor bad?



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 3,144. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

Total good thing = % Very good thing + % Somewhat good thing
Total bad thing = % Very bad thing + % Somewhat bad thing

AI use in political campaign ads without disclosure for deciding which candidates to vote for is considered a *bad thing* by majorities of voters across party. Voters are less skeptical of AI use for information seeking.

When it comes to the 2026 midterm elections, do you think each of the following would generally be a good thing, a bad thing, or neither good nor bad?

Total Bad Thing (% Very bad thing + % Somewhat of a bad thing)	Voters	Democrats	Independents	Republicans
Political campaigns using AI to create content, including advertisements for voters, without disclosing that AI was used in the process	57%	58%	64%	52%
Voters using AI chatbots to decide which candidate to vote for	56%	58%	59%	52%
Candidates using AI to edit or touch-up photos or videos for their political advertisements	49%	49%	55%	45%
Candidates using AI to tailor their political advertisements to individual voters	49%	52%	54%	43%
Candidates using AI chatbots to answer voters' questions about campaigns	48%	51%	51%	44%
Political campaigns using AI to create content, including advertisements for voters, with clear disclosure that AI was used in the process	40%	41%	44%	37%
Voters using AI chatbots to find out information about a candidate or an issue on the ballot	37%	38%	40%	34%
Voters using AI chatbots to find out information about how to cast their ballot	37%	39%	39%	33%
Voters using AI chatbots to learn about how candidates' positions align with their personal values and priorities	36%	37%	43%	30%
Voters using AI chatbots to find information on how to register to vote	32%	35%	34%	28%

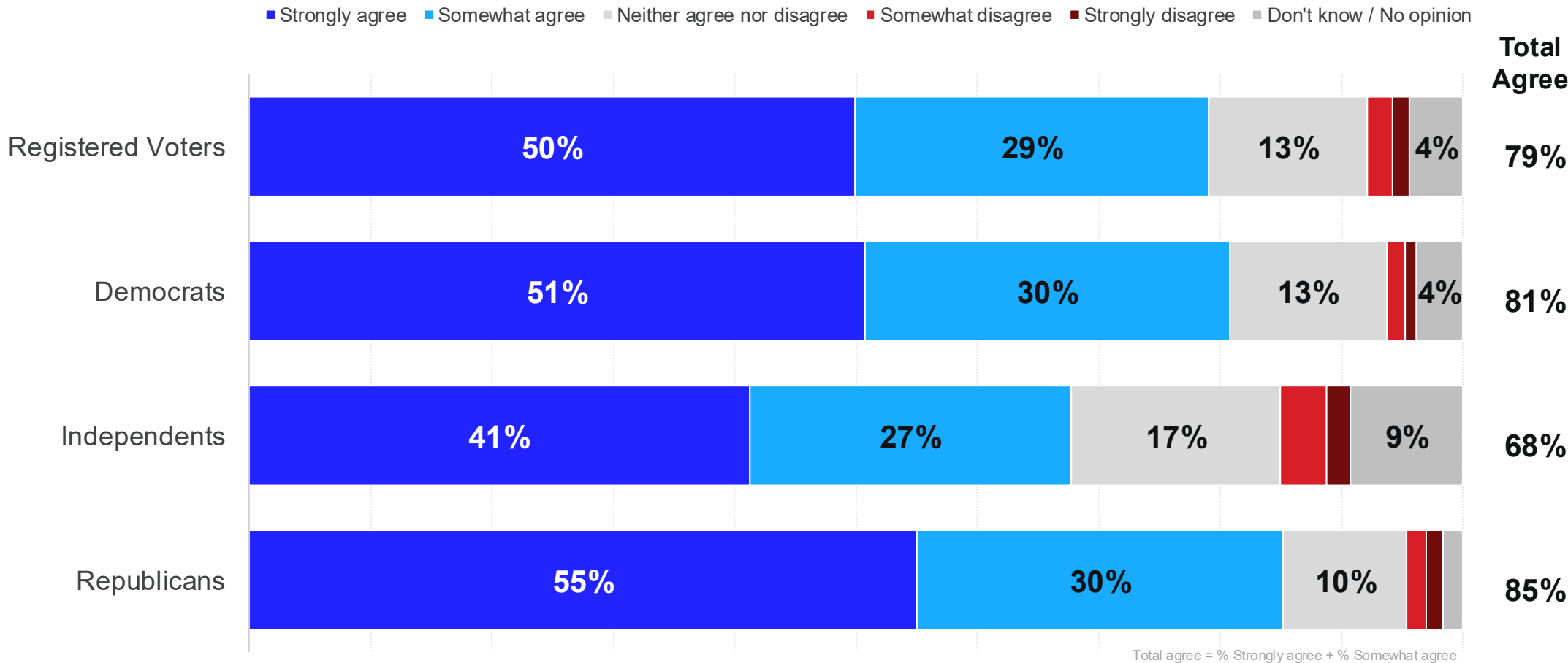
05

Confidence, concerns and policy

Vote-count confidence at four levels of government, fourteen midterm concerns, and four policy questions.

Across party, voters agree their experience in the most recent election they voted in was mostly positive.

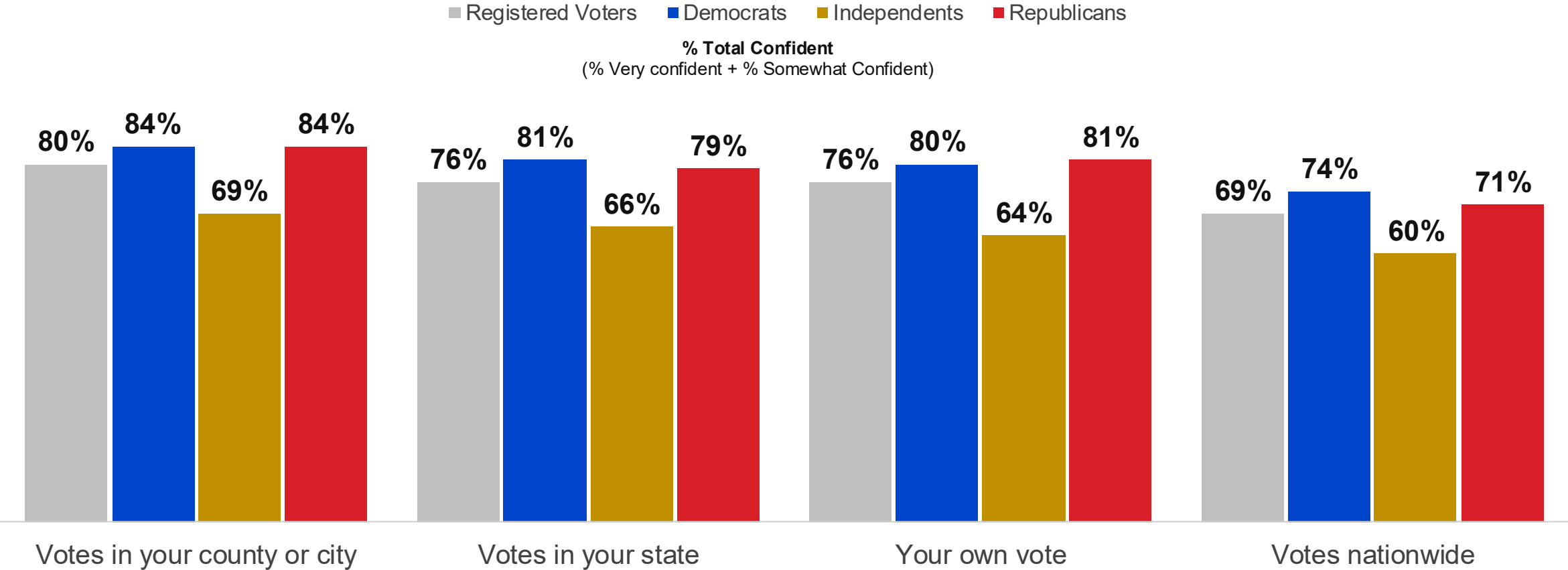
Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? *In the most recent election I voted in, my voting experience was mostly positive.*



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n = 3,144. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

Confidence falls the further the count gets from home — and independents show the lowest confidence in how votes will get counted in November.

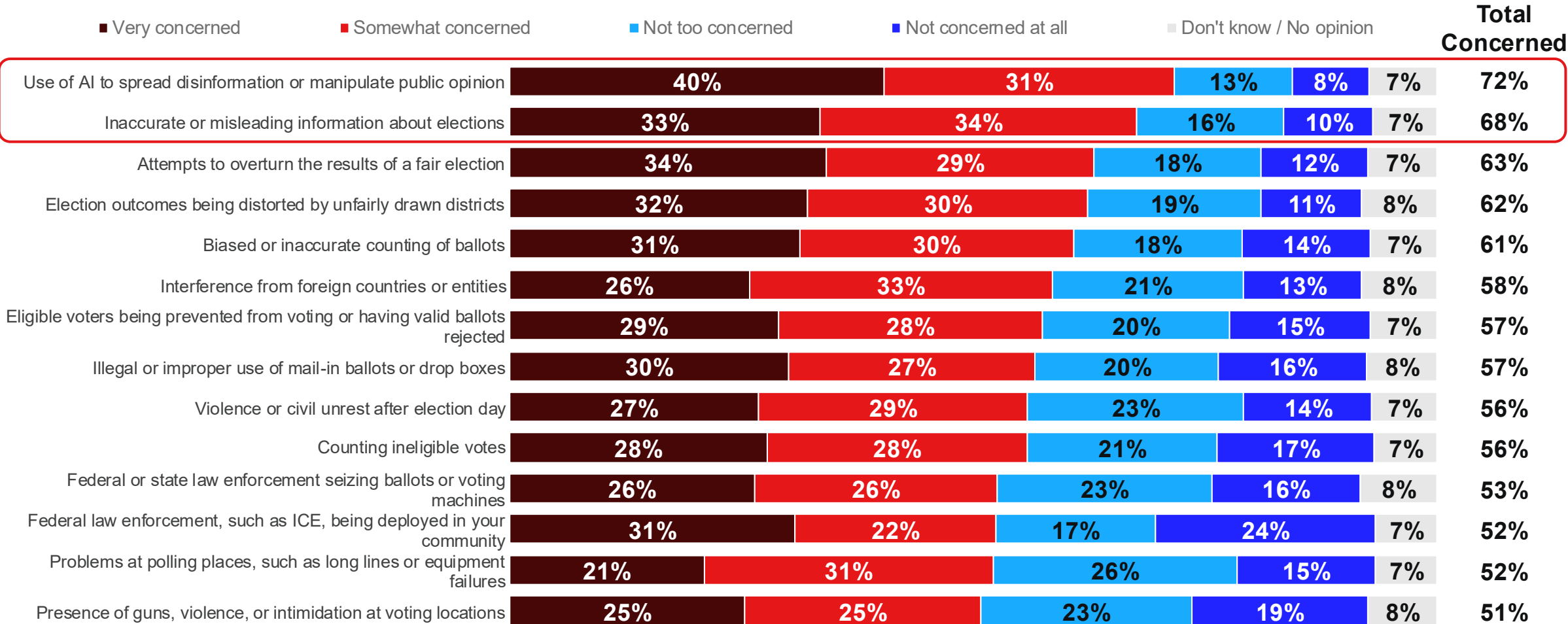
How confident are you that _____ in the November 2026 midterm elections will be counted as you intend?



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n=3,144, Democrats: n = 1,123; Independents: n=816; Republicans: n=1,204

Top concerns ahead of the 2026 midterm elections include misleading information and the use of AI to spread disinformation, with concerns about overturning election results.

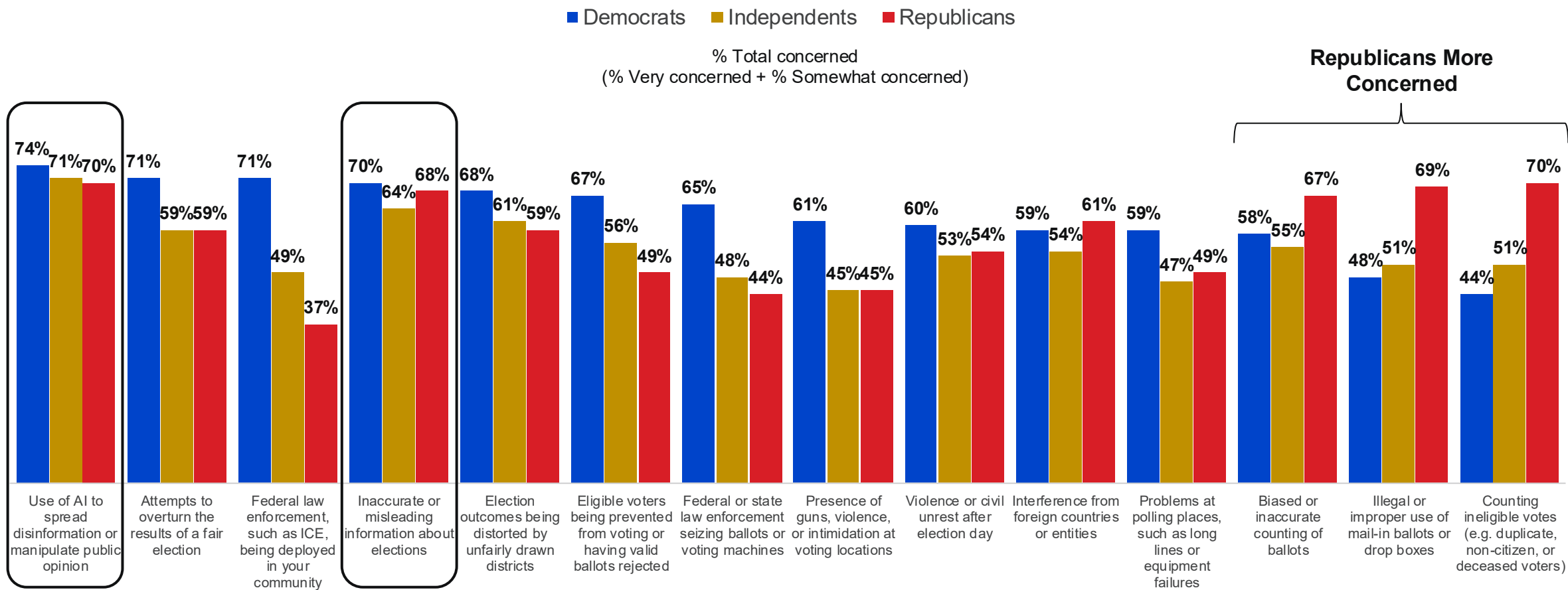
How concerned are you, if at all, about the following when it comes to the 2026 midterm elections?



Total Concerned = % Very concerned + % Somewhat concerned

Concern about AI-driven disinformation and inaccurate information is bipartisan. Democrats and Republicans diverge most on ICE and ineligible votes or mail-in voting fraud.

How concerned are you, if at all, about the following when it comes to the 2026 midterm elections?

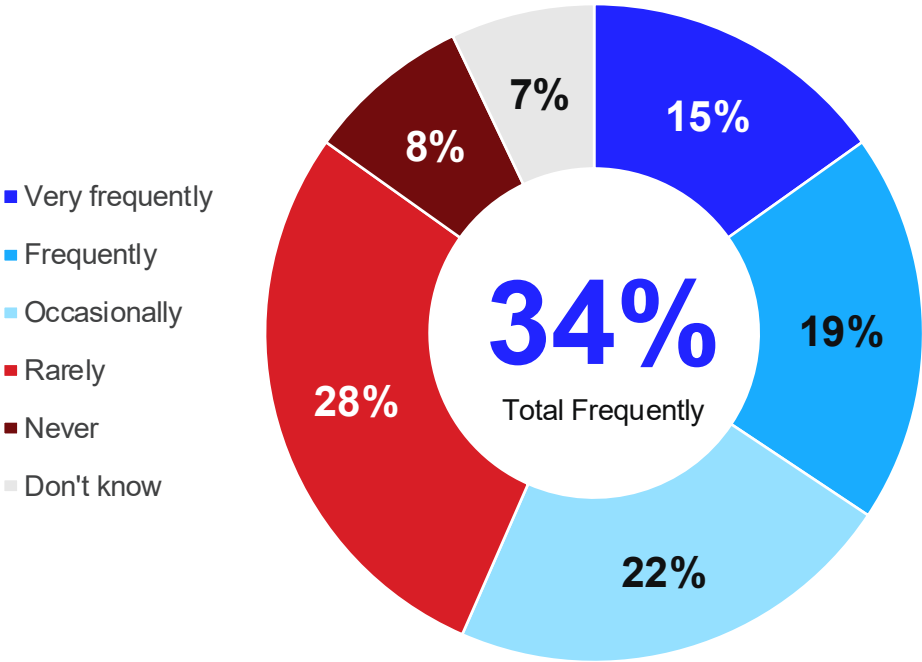


Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Democrats: n = 1,123; Independents: n=816; Republicans: n=1,204. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

Just one-third of voters think illegal voting occurs frequently. Among those who believe it occurs at all, two-in-five believe it can influence election outcomes.

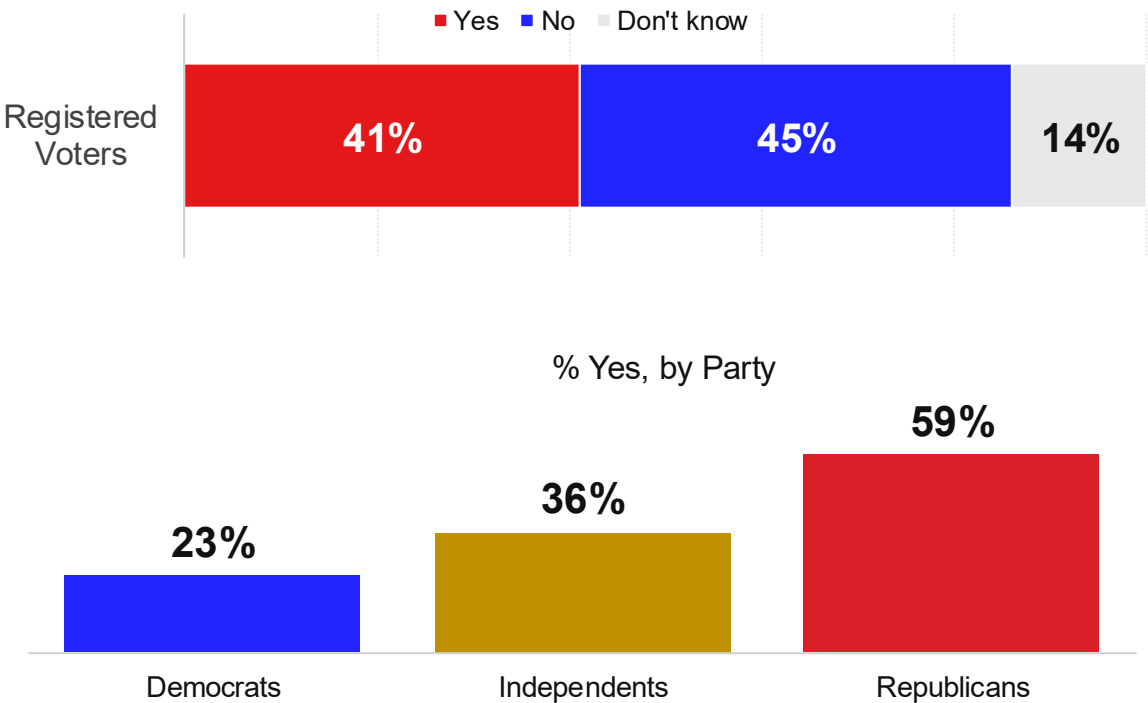
How often does illegal non-citizen voting occur? | Does it occur frequently enough to alter outcomes?

How often does illegal non-citizen voting occur?



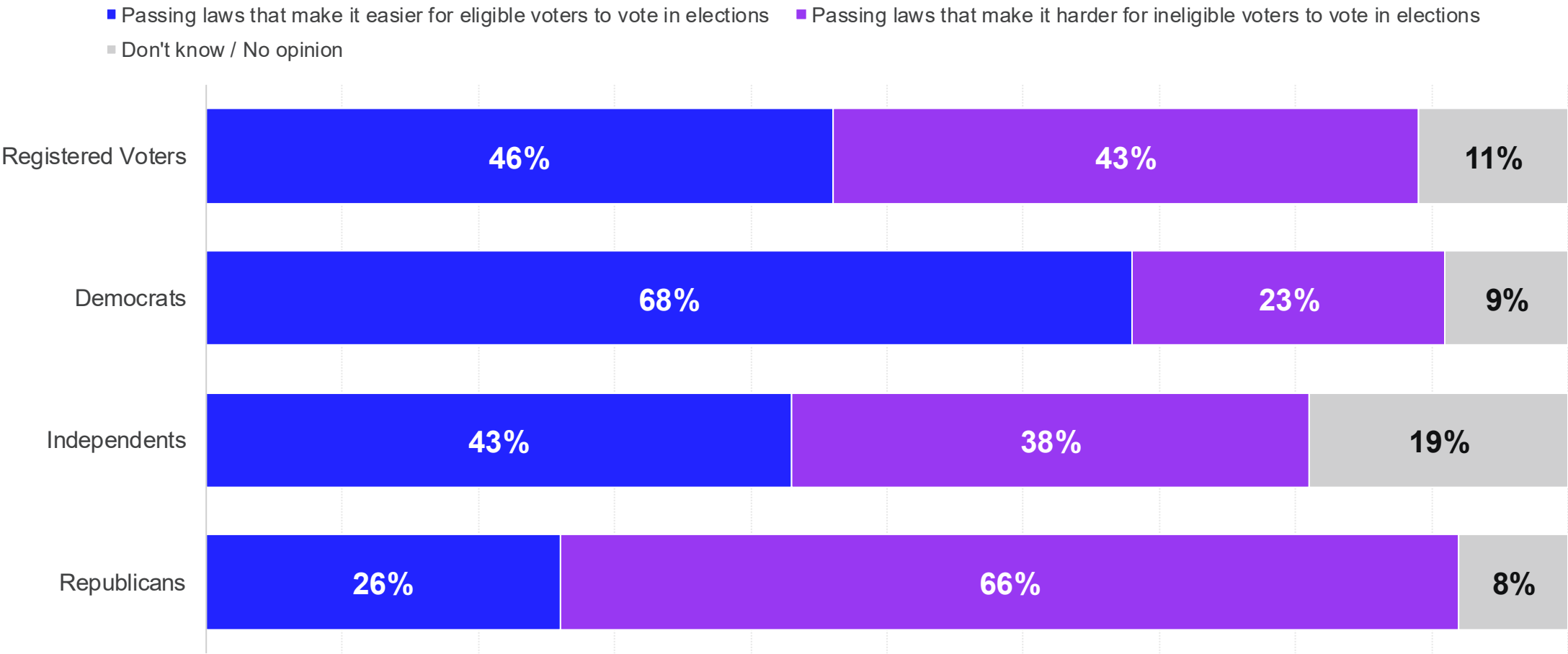
Would you say illegal non-citizen voting occurs frequently enough to alter the outcomes of elections?

n = 2,674



Nearly half of voters think passing laws to make it easier for eligible voters to vote in elections is important. This preference is partisan: Democrats prefer laws to make voting easier, and Republicans prefer laws to restrict ineligible voting.

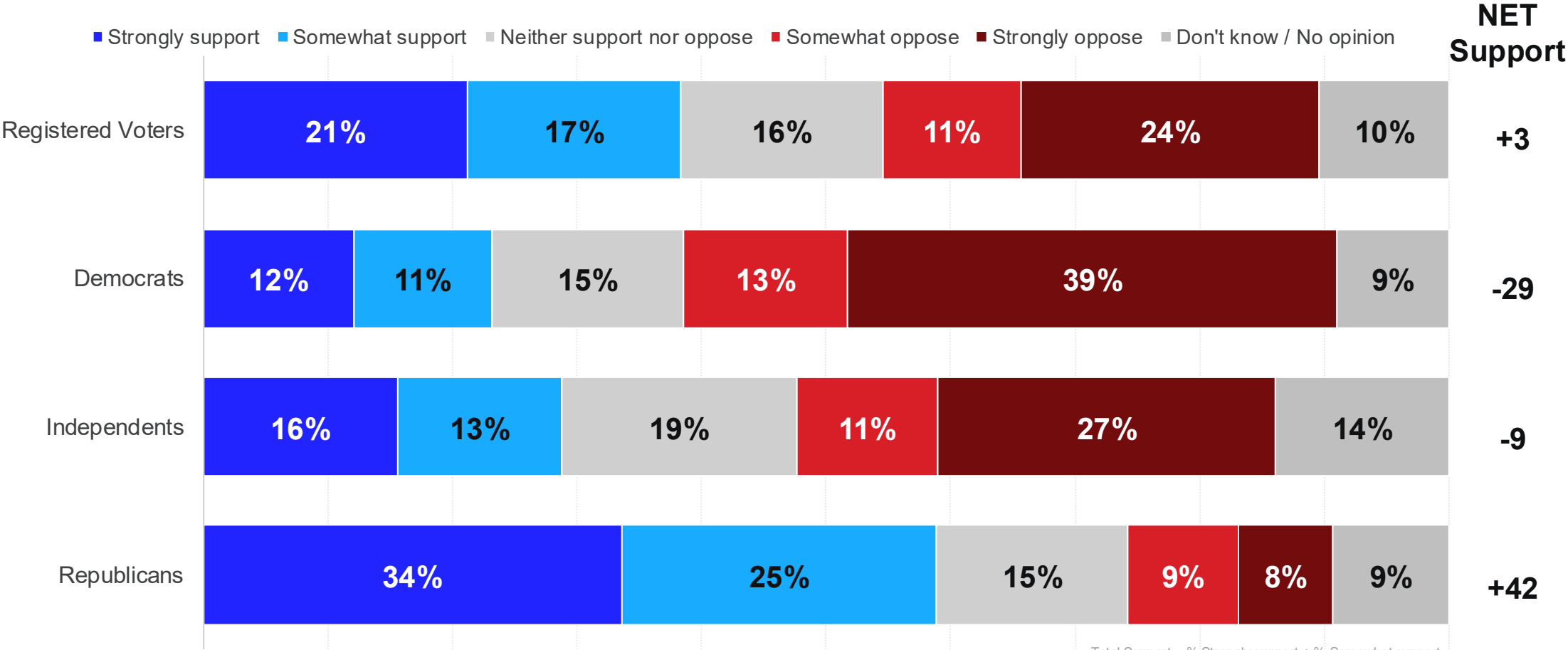
Which is more important to you?



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n=3, 144, Democrats: n = 1,123; Independents: n=816; Republicans: n=1,204.

Voters are split on their stance toward the Postal Service refusing to send mail-in ballots to voters not enrolled with the Postal Service, but this view is sharply partisan. More Democrats oppose the policy (52%), while more Republicans support it (59%).

In August, the Postal Service issued a new policy concerning mail ballots. Under the new policy, the Postal Service could refuse to send mail ballots in states that do not enroll their mail voters with the Postal Service and could refuse to send a ballot to any voter who is not on the state's list. Do you support or oppose this policy?



Source: Morning Consult poll 2608077, fielded 2–4 September 2026 among registered voters. Base: n=3,144, Democrats: n = 1,123; Independents: n=816; Republicans: n=1,204. Figures may not sum to 100 due to rounding.

